

ASHFORD FINANCIAL GROUP

Corporate Technology Procurement

ORIGINAL ISSUE

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

IT Service Management (ITSM) Platform & Managed Helpdesk Services

A technology and managed services modernization initiative

RFP Number	RFP-AFG-2026-0064
Issue Date	February 16, 2026
Proposal Submission Deadline	March 27, 2026, 2:00 PM EST
Issuing Organization	Ashford Financial Group (AFG)
Category	Corporate IT Services — ITSM Platform & Helpdesk Outsourcing
Estimated Contract Value	See Section 13 — Commercial Terms

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1. Introduction & Background

Ashford Financial Group (“AFG” or “the Company”) is a regional bank holding company operating 46 branch locations across five states (Pennsylvania, Ohio, New York, New Jersey, and Delaware), with approximately 2,300 employees. AFG's current IT ticketing platform, TrackIT Legacy, was deployed in 2014 and no longer meets the Company's needs for workflow automation, self-service, and reporting.

AFG is issuing this Request for Proposal (RFP) to solicit qualified vendors to replace its legacy ticketing platform with a modern IT Service Management (ITSM) solution and to provide outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support services.

2. Definitions

Term	Definition
ITSM	IT Service Management — the platform and processes used to manage IT service requests, incidents, and changes.
Helpdesk	The vendor-operated support function that receives, triages, and resolves employee IT service requests.
SLA	Service Level Agreement — a contractually defined performance commitment.
TAM	Technical Account Manager — the vendor's designated point of contact for service escalations.
FFIEC	Federal Financial Institutions Examination Council — issuer of interagency guidance applicable to bank technology vendors.
MSA	Master Services Agreement — the overarching contract governing the vendor relationship.

3. Project Objectives

- Replace the legacy TrackIT ticketing platform with a modern, ITIL v4-aligned ITSM solution.
- Establish outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support to improve first-contact resolution rates.
- Reduce average ticket resolution time by at least 25% within 12 months of go-live.
- Provide employees with a modern self-service portal and knowledge base.
- Maintain compliance with applicable FFIEC guidance on third-party technology service providers throughout the engagement.

4. Scope of Work

1. Design, configure, and deploy a replacement ITSM platform covering incident, request, problem, and change management.
2. Provide outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support for approximately 2,300 AFG employees across 46 branch and corporate locations.
3. Migrate historical ticket data and the configuration management database (CMDB) from the legacy TrackIT platform.
4. Deploy a self-service employee portal with a searchable knowledge base.

5. Integrate the ITSM platform with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory environment for authentication and asset ownership mapping.
6. Provide administrator and power-user training for approximately 60 AFG IT staff.

5. Technical Requirements

5.1 ITSM Platform

- Alignment with ITIL v4 service management practices.
- Built-in configuration management database (CMDB) with automated asset discovery.
- Self-service portal accessible via web browser and a companion mobile app.
- Configurable workflow automation for common request types (password resets, access requests, hardware requests).

5.2 Helpdesk Operations

- Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk coverage during AFG business hours, 7:00 AM – 7:00 PM Eastern Time, Monday through Friday.
- Multichannel intake: phone, email, and self-service portal.
- First-contact resolution target of 70% or higher for Tier 1 tickets.

5.3 Hosting, Availability & Security

- Deployment model: cloud-hosted or on-premise — vendor may propose either model with technical and cost justification.
- System uptime service level agreement (SLA) of 99.5% or higher, measured monthly.
- Single sign-on (SSO) support via SAML 2.0, integrated with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory.
- Encryption at rest (AES-256 or equivalent) and in transit (TLS 1.2 or higher).
- Ticket and activity data retention of a minimum of 3 years.

5.4 System Integrations

- SSO integration with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory environment.
- Read-only data export capability to AFG's core banking platform (FIS) for asset-to-account correlation reporting.

5.5 Vendor Support Responsibilities

The selected vendor's ongoing support obligations shall include the following:

- Maintain a dedicated Tier 1 helpdesk available during AFG business hours for password resets and account lockouts.
- Provide a named Technical Account Manager (TAM) as a single point of contact for service escalations.
- Deliver monthly service performance reports covering ticket volume, resolution time, and SLA compliance.
- Maintain a knowledge base of at least 200 self-service articles, updated quarterly.
- Provide on-site support coverage at AFG's headquarters campus during business hours.

6. Vendor Onboarding & Staffing Requirements

All vendor personnel assigned to this engagement are subject to the following onboarding and staffing requirements:

- All vendor personnel with access to AFG systems must pass a background check consistent with FFIEC guidance prior to engagement.
- Vendor staff must complete AFG's security awareness training within 5 business days of assignment.
- Vendor must maintain a current staffing roster and notify AFG of any personnel changes within 2 business days.
- On-site vendor personnel must badge in and out through AFG's physical access control system.
- Vendor may not subcontract any portion of the helpdesk service without prior written approval from AFG.

7. Functional Requirements Matrix

Vendors must indicate compliance with each functional requirement in their proposal response using the codes: F (Fully Compliant), P (Partially Compliant — explain), C (Customization Required), N (Not Supported).

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Self-service password reset with MFA verification	Mandatory
FR-02	Automated ticket routing based on category and priority	Mandatory
FR-03	Configurable SLA timers with automated escalation	Mandatory
FR-04	CMDB with automated asset discovery	Mandatory
FR-05	Employee satisfaction survey after ticket closure	Desired
FR-06	Native mobile app for ticket submission and tracking	Desired

8. Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for consideration, vendors must meet all of the following minimum criteria:

- Minimum of 5 years of experience providing ITSM platforms and/or managed helpdesk services to financial institutions.
- Minimum annual revenue of \$8,000,000 (audited financials for the most recent fiscal year required).
- At least 4 reference implementations for organizations with 1,500 or more employees, completed within the past 5 years.
- Minimum insurance coverage: \$3,000,000 general liability; \$2,000,000 professional liability/E&O; \$2,000,000 cyber liability.

9. Deliverables

#	Deliverable	Due
1	Project Charter & Implementation Plan	30 days after contract award
2	ITSM Platform System Design Document	60 days after contract award
3	CMDB & Legacy Data Migration Completion Report	Prior to go-live
4	Self-Service Portal & Knowledge Base Launch	Per go-live milestone
5	Helpdesk Transition & Ramp-Up Plan	45 days after contract award
6	Training Materials & Delivered Sessions (60 IT staff)	Prior to go-live
7	Final Documentation Package	Project close-out

10. Project Timeline

Milestone	Date
RFP Issue Date	February 16, 2026
Vendor Q&A Deadline	March 2, 2026
Proposal Submission Deadline	March 27, 2026
Shortlist Notification	April 10, 2026
Vendor Presentations	April 20 – 24, 2026
Contract Award	May 8, 2026
Project Kickoff	May 26, 2026
Helpdesk Transition Complete	August 2026
ITSM Platform Go-Live	October 2026
Full Project Completion	December 2026

11. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be scored on a 100-point scale as follows:

Criterion	Weight
Technical Solution & Architecture	30 points
Vendor Experience & References	20 points
Implementation Timeline	15 points
Cost	25 points
Support & Maintenance Plan	10 points

12. Insurance Requirements

- Commercial General Liability: \$3,000,000 per occurrence.
- Professional Liability / Errors & Omissions: \$2,000,000 per claim.
- Cyber Liability: \$2,000,000 per occurrence, covering data breach and business interruption.
- AFG and its officers, agents, and employees must be named as additional insureds on all policies except professional liability.

13. Commercial Terms

Estimated Project Budget: \$2,600,000 – \$3,400,000

Contract Term: 24 months, with one (1) optional 12-month renewal.

Payment Schedule

- 20% upon contract signing
- 30% upon helpdesk transition completion
- 30% upon ITSM platform go-live
- 20% upon final acceptance

Other Commercial Terms

- Warranty period: 12 months following go-live, covering defect remediation at no additional cost.
- Payment terms: Net 45 from invoice date.
- No liquidated damages clause applies to this engagement.

14. Submission Instructions

Proposals must be submitted electronically in PDF format to procurement@ashfordfg.com no later than the deadline listed above. Proposals must remain valid for 120 days from the submission deadline. A sealed hard copy is not required. Late submissions will not be considered.

15. Terms & Conditions

15.1 Governing Law

This RFP and any resulting contract shall be governed by the laws of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania.

15.2 Confidentiality

All proposal materials submitted become the property of AFG and will be treated as confidential business information, subject to standard non-disclosure obligations between the parties.

15.3 Reservation of Rights

AFG reserves the right to reject any or all proposals, waive minor irregularities, and negotiate final contract terms with the selected vendor.

15.4 Intellectual Property

All custom configurations, integrations, and documentation developed specifically for AFG under this engagement shall become the property of AFG upon final payment. Vendor retains ownership of pre-existing, generally licensed software.

16. Contact Information

Issuing Officer	Nathan Boyd
Title	IT Procurement Manager
Email	nboyd@ashfordfg.com
Phone	(717) 555-0142

Appendix A: Pricing Form

Vendors must complete the following pricing form in full. Unit prices must be all-inclusive of labor, materials, travel, and overhead unless otherwise noted.

Line Item	Description	Price
A-1	ITSM Platform Licensing (2,300 users)	\$_____
A-2	ITSM Implementation & Configuration Services	\$_____
A-3	Managed Helpdesk Services (Annual, Tier 1 & 2)	\$_____
A-4	Legacy Data & CMDB Migration Services	\$_____
A-5	Self-Service Portal & Knowledge Base Setup	\$_____
A-6	Training (60 IT Staff)	\$_____
A-7	Total Proposed Price	\$_____

Appendix B: Reference Form

Provide at least 4 references meeting the eligibility criteria in Section 8. Duplicate this table as needed.

Field	Response
Client Organization	
Contact Name & Title	
Phone / Email	
Project Scope Summary	
Employees Supported	
Contract Value	
Completion Date	

Appendix C: Compliance Certification Checklist

Requirement	Certified (Y/N)
Vendor meets minimum 5 years relevant experience	
Vendor meets minimum annual revenue threshold	
Vendor holds required insurance coverage	
Vendor's proposed platform supports SSO via SAML 2.0	
Vendor's helpdesk model meets coverage-hours requirement	